

Healing Glaucoma

Natural Medicine for Self-Healing: Starter Excerpt

by Rev. Dr. Glen Swartwout, A.B., B.D., O.D., N.D., F.I.C.A.N.,
F.C.S.O.

What follows is drawn from the opening pages of *Healing Glaucoma*, plus the short passage near the book's end where Dr. Glen tells his own story. It is offered here exactly as he wrote it, lightly arranged, so you can hear directly from him before deciding whether to go further.

Foreword

If you are reading this book as a patient, self-healer or caregiver seeking answers beyond those offered by your eye doctor, I am glad that you are here on the threshold of what I hope and pray will be a most productive journey of learning, exploring and healing for you... not only for your eyes and your vision, but for your life... in all the many aspects that go into a complete picture of health, and a sense of purpose, meaning and direction in life. After all, not only are healthy eyes important to serve the essential function of vision, but improving and safeguarding our vision is important to serve the sentient life of our consciousness, our mind, our soul.

Vision is ultimately a core function of our true selves as navigational spiritual beings, not merely a biophysical transduction of photons to electrical nerve current, though that is the foundation upon which we learn to derive meaning from the select visible octave of frequencies of quantum energy that is also the source of most biological energy itself, received from the sun, and captured

in all the covalent bonds of carbon chemistry that constantly re-constructs the standing waves that are these bodies through which we experience the gift that is this life.

If you are a practitioner of the healing arts, congratulations! I applaud the openness of your mind, and your heart's unfettered motivation for seeking out answers for healing those souls who put their faith and trust in your guidance, wherever that quest may lead you... It is a sacred trust, which we should hold dear. Never allow the pressures for human respect by your peers, nor for worldly treasure sway you from seeking truth, and offering it freely to those who can hear. The riches you will store in Heaven's true economy of sacred gifts will enrich your own spirit, and the lives of all you touch. My father, who was also a pioneering eye doctor in the fields of functional, behavioral, developmental and rehabilitative optometry, told me when I first began to practice with him, "You have learned a lot, enough to start practicing... Listen to your patients. They will teach you the rest." He was a good doctor, and a wise man who had practiced what he preached. His admonition beats the usual warning given physicians in medical school: "Don't listen to your patients. They have no medical training. They will throw you off track..."

I am still listening to each person who seeks my guidance, and after four and a half decades, I am still amazed at the rich tapestry from which to learn from the unique experiences and observations of each human being in the process of living, learning, growing and healing... from the intricacies of the body's inner linguistics to the transcendent gestalt of unique personhood that hovers beyond words... from the flavor of each personality, unique from conception, to the radiant sense of overarching coherence between the biological challenges of the living vessel, and the psycho-emotional life of the conscious spirit itself, the ghost within the machine of life, that is the reason we seek a deeper way of healing!

Preface

This book has been growing over the years... contributed to in various stages as I began researching the relationship between vision and nutrition when I opened my first professional practice in 1982, the Optometric Center of Tokyo. I interned with a number of leading nutritionally oriented Doctors of Optometry including Conrad Mazeski, Don Getz, Ben Lane, Moses Albalas and Robert Kaplan. I was asked to speak to an international meeting of the International College of Applied Nutrition, of which I was a Fellow, and this stimulated the beginnings of formalizing and organizing my thinking and knowledge base in this vitally important, relatively untapped area of health care. The individualized clinical application of natural methods for accelerating self-healing of eye diseases such as glaucoma remains in its infancy four and a half decades later. My hope is that this introductory guide and reference book can help those who are called to explore and pioneer this fertile terrain for the benefit of future generations.

Introduction

This book is offered as a tour guide, a sort of black book survey of potential solutions that have already proven useful for others seeking outside the paradigmatic box of modern conventions in med-surge medicine, for how the body can heal in the face of glaucoma.

These solutions have worked for many people in my healing practice over the past four and a half decades, and they have worked for me personally. Without them, I would have been expected to be blind for the past two decades. Not only have I retained my vision without eye drops or surgical intervention, I have experienced the side benefits of hundreds of non-toxic, natural therapies designed to improve other supportive body functions over the years to achieve this. Eyes do not get sick... or well... in a vacuum. Eyes depend upon nutrients to function properly and re-

pair themselves. Nutrients are supplied to the eyes by the digestive system via the circulatory system, pumped by the heart, oxygenated by the lungs, cleansed by the liver and kidneys, and wastes are drained by the lymph system, and the list goes on...

The most efficient way to healthier eyes, and the healing of the underlying causes of glaucoma, is to heal the whole person, one step at a time, according to the priorities identified by the body's own healing and communication systems. Fortunately, we now have methods to tap into this communication system, more or less like hooking up a modern car to a diagnostic computer. And through the holographic nature of the body's design, we can do that non-invasively, through electrodermal measurements of the body's purposeful responses to signals, the same kind of signals the body itself uses for internal regulation. This new language of the body's biological energy field, or biofield, allows me to ask directly whether a given tissue is calling out in distress, and whether a particular medicine carries the signature of healing energy it can utilize to complete its mission for healing that distress. This is a process which is ongoing in the body every second we are alive... It's just now that we are beginning to learn how to listen...

For most of my career, that listening asked for trained hands and sensitive instruments, one point and one question at a time. The most recent advance changes the reach of it. We can now read the body's signals in the voice itself. A short voice recording carries the same field information, and frequency analysis of that recording lets us hear where the terrain is calling for support and which remedies resonate with the healing that is already under way. What once required an afternoon in a practitioner's office can now begin with a few spoken words from anywhere in the world.

"Eye pressure at Hawaiian Eye Clinic: 42 & 46. One month later, eye pressure at Hawaiian Eye Clinic: 30 & 31 without using any eye drops or chemical drugs. Used only herbal caps of Forskohlii," noted Dr. Kuakiniokalani Keeaumoku Kawananaoka-Pribble, His

Serene Highness, Hawaiian Prince and European Royal who grew up in Buckingham Palace.

The ophthalmologist at Hawaiian Eye, the #1 eye clinic in Hawaii, had prescribed eye drops, which he had informed Dr. Kuakini he did not expect to work. He was amazed at the reduced eye pressures, thinking that the prescription had worked.

When Dr. Kuakini informed him that he had not filled the prescription, since he was told they would not work anyway, but had instead taken an herbal remedy, the ophthalmologist was even more amazed and said that it was the first time he had ever seen a natural substance reduce a patient's eye pressure.

Glaucoma Solutions

Glaucoma actually represents many different diseases, affecting all age groups from newborns to the elderly. It can be very painful, or can progress without any symptoms. Glaucoma is a major cause of irreversible blindness. Glaucoma is often associated with high pressure in the eyes, however a high percentage of people with glaucoma have normal or even low pressure. Ultimately, the final cause of vision loss in each type of glaucoma is an inability to get the needed nutrients to the cells of the retina and optic nerve, as well as to remove metabolic wastes and any other toxins that may be present in these tissues of the central nervous system.

Medical and surgical controls of intraocular pressure are sometimes necessary and should be utilized when less invasive means of management alone are insufficient. Drugs and surgery appear to suppress glaucoma damage only for a limited time for each individual, though. Drugs and surgery do not correct or eliminate the underlying causes of disease, which are always individual and typically multi-factorial. Learning more about your biochemical individuality and how to be a good steward of your body are necessary

in order to achieve your optimum potential for health and longevity.

Natural Medicine for Healing Glaucoma

Let's begin the journey through the array of potential natural solutions, many of which are assured to be beneficial or even crucial in eventually eliminating, as much as feasible, the multi-factorial causality of the particular type of glaucoma, which is ultimately unique to the physiology and pathophysiology of each individual at a given time in the progression of the disease and its potential reversal.

This is where the personalized Glaucoma Support Program comes in. Rather than handing everyone the same list of supplements and hoping it fits, the program begins by listening to your own biology and building the response around what your eyes are actually asking for. It follows two tracks, because glaucoma is not one condition. If your eye pressure runs high, the elevated-pressure track adds targeted pressure regulation to the daily foundation. If your pressure sits in the normal range and yet your optic nerve is still losing ground, the normal-tension track sets the pressure work aside and concentrates on circulation, neuroprotection and the terrain around the nerve. In both tracks the foundation is the same whole-person core: neuroprotection, healthy circulation to the eye, restorative support through the day and the night, and the omega-3 fats the optic nerve depends on. And in both tracks the program is meant to sit alongside your regular eye-care monitoring, never to replace it. Glaucoma can advance quietly, so we keep watching the pressures and the visual fields while the natural support does its slower, deeper work.

Afterword: The Author's Own Story

The author was a 25-year-old interning eye doctor at the world's largest outpatient vision clinic in New York City, and president of the American Optometric Student Association, representing over 4,000 student doctors of optometry worldwide, when he learned that he had glaucoma. Knowing that the best medical and surgical treatment would likely leave him blind before age 50, he embarked on his continuing investigation of alternative, complementary, and integrative medical approaches to the treatment, prevention and rehabilitation of glaucoma and other eye and vision conditions. Four and a half decades later, he continues to maintain his vision without suppressive eye drops or invasive eye surgery.

There is much more waiting for you. This starter excerpt is only the foreword, preface, introduction, and the opening of the first chapter of *Healing Glaucoma*. The full book goes on to walk through the rest of Dr. Glen's decades of clinical research and personal practice, chapter by chapter: biological terrain and diet, neuroprotection, antioxidants and free electrons, minerals, vitamins, essential fatty acids, botanicals, homeopathy, and the energetic biofeedback methods he uses to match each remedy to each person's own physiology.

If what you've just read resonates with where you are right now, whether you're newly diagnosed, managing glaucoma long-term, or supporting someone who is, the full book is the next step. And if you'd rather talk it through with a real person before you dive in, Dr. Glen still makes time to sit with people navigating exactly this. Reach out and start that conversation.